PP–T–576a
28 MAY 1954
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. PP–T–00576 (GSA–FSS)
28 September 1953 and
Fed. Spec. PP–T–576
8 June 1938

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TONGUES, BEEF; FRESH, CURED, OR SMOKED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Types, classes, grades, weight ranges, and states of refrigeration.—Beef tongues covered by this specification shall be of the following types, classes, grades, weight ranges, and states of refrigeration, as specified (see 6.1).

1.1.1 *Types:*

Type I.—Standard (commercially prepared) (see 3.2.1)

Type II.—Special (prepared under direct official supervision) (see 3.2.2)

1.1.2 *Classes:*

Class A.—Fresh
Class B.—Cured
Class C.—Smoked

1.1.3 *Grades:*

Grade 1.—(see 3.4.1)
Grade 2.—(see 3.4.2)

1.1.4 *Weight ranges:*

Lightweight (L) (2½ to 3½ pounds)
Heavyweight (H) (3½ pounds or more)

1.1.5 *States of refrigeration:*

Chilled (see 3.5.1)
Frozen (see 3.5.2)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications.—There are no other specifications applicable to this specification except those referenced in section 7 by individual departments.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under "General Information" in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the GSA Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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2.2 **Other publications.** — The following publications, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

Regulations Governing the Meat Inspection of the United States Department of Agriculture.

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

(Regulations governing Meat Inspection of the United States Department of Agriculture may be obtained from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Meat Inspection, Washington 25, D. C.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Material.**—The beef tongues shall be sound, well-trimmed beef tongues, selected, prepared, and handled in accordance with good commercial practices, and meeting the requirements herein as applicable for each respective type, class, grade, weight range, and state of refrigeration specified. The tongues shall be of standard conventional short-cut trim, that is, well trimmed with the tongue root smoothly removed at the base (thick) end, by a cut made close to, and directly behind, the hyoid (U shaped) bones, and practicably all major glandular tissue and the rings of the trachea (windpipe) closely removed and excluded. Unless otherwise specified, the hyoid bones, cartilages, and the epiglottis (soft palate) may be left on the tongue. Frayed edges, semi-loose pieces of flesh, and fat in excess of 1 inch in thickness on any surface shall be smoothly removed and excluded. Major blood vessels located at both sides of the butt end of the tongue which are customarily used for arterial pumping and curing, shall remain intact and practically undamaged until curing is completed. The tongues shall be free from discoloration (natural pigmentation such as black tips or dark colored outer membrane will be acceptable), mucous, extraneous matter, freezer burn, foreign odor or flavor, or other detrimental deterioration or damage. Components and ingredients used in preparing the product shall be of kinds conventionally used, which are sound and of good quality. The beef tongues shall be in excellent condition to the time of delivery.

3.2 **Description of types.**—When the type of the product is not specified, the beef tongues shall be of type I (see 3.2.1).

3.2.1 *Type I, standard.* — Type I beef tongue shall be the standard commercially prepared product customarily available, but which was not prepared under special official supervision. Type I beef tongues shall be subject to acceptance or rejection at the time and place offered on the basis of physical characteristics evidenced in the product as meeting the requirements specified.

3.2.2 *Type II, special.* — Type II beef tongue shall be prepared under the direct supervision of especially assigned Government agents responsible for determining and assuring compliance with the requirements specified. Frozen or defrosted beef tongues shall not be used for curing or for smoking type II beef tongues which require delivery in a frozen state. Beef tongues used for curing or for smoking, which do not require subsequent freezing for delivery may be prepared from suitably defrosted frozen stock,

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provided the tongues show no evidence of freezer damage, or other detrimental deterioration or damage.

3.3 Description of classes.—Description of classes shall be such of the classes (A through C) defined herein, as specified.

3.3.1 *Class A, fresh.*—Class A fresh beef tongue shall be the uncured and unsmoked product delivered in either the chilled or frozen state, as specified.

3.3.2 *Class B, cured.*—Class B beef tongue shall be the cured (see 3.3.2.1) unsmoked product, delivered in either the chilled or frozen state, as specified.

3.3.2.1 *Curing.*—The product shall be thoroughly but not excessively cured in a well-blended mixture of salt, with either or both, sodium nitrate and sodium nitrite, and with or without sugar (or other permissible sweetening agent), and water, by any recognized and approved conventional method. The cured tongues shall possess a bright and uniform (slight two-toned permissible) stable cured color, and be practically free from discoloration, or evidence of faulty ("over or under") curing and handling, and detrimental deterioration or damage.

3.3.2.2 *Draining and weighing.* — Unless otherwise specified, the marked and invoiced net weight of class B cured beef tongues shall be established as prescribed herein according to method No. 1 for type I, standard, and method No. 2 for type II, special.

3.3.2.2.1 *Method No. 1.*—The net weight of class B cured beef tongues shall be determined and assured by the vendor at the time and place offered, in a manner to compensate for subsequent drainage in transit, so that the cured and drained beef tongues shall weigh not less than the marked and invoiced net weight as determined promptly at time of delivery at the domestic point of destination, or if delivered in pickle or in an unusually wet and dripping condition, after appropriate draining and weighing in accordance with method No. 2 (3.3.2.2.2).

3.3.2.2.2 *Method No. 2.*—The net weight of class B cured beef tongues shall be determined and established by weighing the product at the time of packaging (or delivery as applicable) after appropriate draining for not less than 24 hours. Draining shall be conducted in suitable temperatures (32°-40° F.) on conventional, horizontal, slatted racks customarily used for the purpose, with the tongues piled thereon to a depth not exceeding 2 feet in height, or in lieu thereof, by draining under similar conditions while suspended on vertical racks equipped with hangers, hooks, or a device giving equivalent satisfactory results. The drained product shall be fairly devoid of surface and dripping moisture at the time of weighing.

3.3.3 *Class C, smoked.* — Class C beef tongues shall be the cured (3.3.2.1) smoked (3.3.3.1) product, delivered in either the chilled or frozen state as specified. The cured beef tongues shall be washed or soaked as necessary, and adequately drained prior to smoking to remove extraneous matter and preclude salt encrustation and exuding moisture after smoking. Individual tongues may be smoked in stockinettes or artificial casings without unduly creasing or misshaping the product. Strings, hangers, and stockinettes shall be removed prior to weighing and packaging. Unless otherwise specified, the smoked tongues may be snugly encased in fairly transparent casings without unduly affecting the characteristics (shape, trim, condition, etc.) necessary to determine compliance with requirements. A good grade of dissolved clear gelatin may be used for momentary dipping the tongue to facilitate stuffing in casings, provided it does not leave an appreciable amount of gelatinous material between the tongue and the casing.

3.3.3.1 *Smoking.*—Unless otherwise specified, or as applicable in section 7, the cured

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trimmed beef tongues shall be well-smoked in a normal natural dry smoke from burning hardwood, or hardwood sawdust, or both, for a sufficient time with temperatures as necessary to appropriately dry the product, and to impart a uniform bright, well-penetrated smoke color, and the characteristic smoked appearance, texture, aroma, flavor, and firmness to the finished product. The chilled (3.5.1) smoked beef tongues shall be moderately firm and smooth, shall possess an attractive recently smoked appearance, and be practicably free from rendered fat, wrinkles, ashes, encrusted salt, streaks, and soft, or unsmoked sections, and shall not exceed the weight of the trimmed fresh (uncured) tongue.

3.4 Description of grades.—Description of grades shall be as specified in 3.4.1 and 3.4.2. When the grade of the product is not specified, the beef tongue shall meet the requirements according to grade 1.

3.4.1 *Grade 1.*—Grade 1 beef tongues shall be of excellent quality; that is, they shall be of good proportions, being relatively short, thick, uniformly full, plump, and symmetrical, shall possess a fine smooth texture, and be firm and resilient. The membranous covering shall be thin, smooth (except the tip), and pliable; the flesh shall have a bright and fairly uniform color, and the finished product shall possess the characteristics associated with the class (fresh, cured, or smoked) of product specified. The underside of the butt portion of the tongue shall be fairly well covered with fat of good character which is firm and smooth. Grade 1 beef tongues shall be practicably free from blemishes, which shall not exceed two slight cuts or scores confined to the long or tip end, and which do not interfere with the making of satisfactory slices.

3.4.2 *Grade 2.*—Grade 2 beef tongues shall be of good quality; that is, they shall be of fairly good proportions, being at least fairly short, thick, plump and symmetrical, shall possess a moderately fine smooth texture and be fairly firm and resilient. The membranous covering shall be fairly thin, smooth (except the tip) and pliable, the flesh shall have a fairly bright, uniform (slight two-toned permissible) color, and the finished product shall possess the characteristics associated with the class (fresh, cured, or smoked) of product specified. The underside of the butt portion shall be moderately well covered with fat of fairly good character, being at least moderately firm and smooth. Grade 2 beef tongues shall be fairly free from blemishes other than a few slight cuts, or scores, or cut off tip ends, which do not interfere with the making of satisfactory slices.

3.5 Description of states of refrigeration.—When the state of refrigeration is not specified, the finished product shall be delivered in a well-chilled state without evidence of freezing or defrosting.

3.5.1 *Chilled.*—The beef tongues shall be thoroughly chilled but not frozen in suitable temperatures pertinent to the class of product specified in accordance with the following schedule:

Class and product	*Temperature range*
A—Fresh beef tongues	28° — 40° F.
B—Cured beef tongues	25° — 40° F.
C—Smoked beef tongues	28° — 55° F.

The tongues shall be suitably spaced (piled not more than 1 deep) or individually suspended for chilling without crowding or unnecessary contact with equipment, to facilitate rapid chilling, air circulation, and drying. The product and the packages shall be reasonably dry and free from condensation and contamination. The chilled tongues shall be maintained and delivered in a well-chilled state and in excellent condition.

3.5.2 *Frozen.*—Beef tongues which have been chilled and handled as specified in 3.5.1, shall be promptly and thoroughly frozen. Prior to freezing, the tongues shall be either individually wrapped and completely covered with suitable waxed or parchment paper, and

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neatly and closely packaged side by side in layers in the container, or when the tongues are not individually wrapped, they shall be closely and neatly placed side by side, not more than one tongue in depth per layer, in two reasonably uniform layers in the container, with the under (flesh) side towards the center of the container, and preferably with a separator of waxed paper or paper board between the two layers, or the tongues may be packaged in any conventional manner which permits ready examination of individual frozen tongues for conformance with prescribed requirements. The chilled packaged tongues shall be frozen as expeditiously as practicable with suitable spacing (racks or slats) in a sharp freezer to an internal temperature not higher than 10° F., or in a wind tunnel in suitable and practicably uniform temperatures (which are not higher than 0° F.), or by other means giving equivalent rapid results. The frozen tongues shall be held in suitable storage with temperatures not above 6° F. until shipment is made, but shall not be frozen longer than is necessary to thoroughly freeze the amount required for prompt delivery as scheduled, or not in excess of 60 days, whichever is the lesser period, or as may be specified. The frozen beef tongues shall be maintained in a thoroughly frozen state and in excellent condition to the time of delivery.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.—All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and the regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.7 Meat inspection act.—The beef tongues shall be prepared only in an establishment which is regularly operated under the supervision of Meat Inspection, U. S. Department of Agriculture, and shall be inspected, passed, and marked in accordance with the regulations governing meat inspection of the U. S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Sanitation and workmanship.—Beef tongues shall be handled and delivered under the same sanitary conditions as govern the handling and movement of similar products within and between establishments maintained under Federal Meat Inspection.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.*—Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of preparation, both during and after fabrication, at a suitable point in transit or after delivery to the point of destination. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.2 *Final inspection.*—Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* — Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the methods of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on date of invitation for bids.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.—Unless otherwise specified, commercial packaging will be acceptable.

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5.2 **Labeling.**—Any commercial labeling or additional labeling that complies with the Federal Meat Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder, will be acceptable under this specification.

5.3 **Packing.**—Unless otherwise specified, the product shall be delivered in standard commercial containers of the type, size, and kind customarily used for the purpose, so constructed and applied as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery.

5.3.1 *Marking of shipping containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be legibly marked with the name and complete description of the material or end product as necessary and applicable, such as the kind, type, class, grade, weight range, state of refrigeration, number of pieces, and the total quantity (net weight) in the container, the gross weight, etc., according to the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of the contractor, the name of the manufacturer (if other than the contractor), number of the contract or order, date of packing, and such other pertinent data for identifying the product as may be specified by individual agencies.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.**—Invitations for bids should state the precise details of the required type, class, grade, weight range, state of refrigeration of the product, and where applicable the style of packaging desired (see 1.1).

6.2 Type I fresh, (a) chilled, (b) frozen, and type II, cured and smoked of Federal Specification PP-T-576 are no longer applicable and have been superseded by classes (fresh, cured, and smoked), and by states of refrigeration (chilled and frozen) (see 1.1.2 and 1.1.5).

6.3 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, weight ranges and states of refrigeration of beef tongues that are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.4 If for any particular purpose samples with bids are necessary, they shall be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated.

6.5 **Contractor's inspection.**—The contractor's obligation and responsibility requires such performance and his detailed inspection to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to its submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.6 **Destination inspection.**—When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

7.1 The following specification of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, form a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

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7.2 **Army, Navy, and Air Force.**

7.2.1 *Applicable specification.*

Military Specification:

MIL-P-1018—Packaging of Meat Cuts and Sausage Products (Chilled or Frozen) for Domestic and Overseas Shipment.

(Copies of specifications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer. Both the title and identifying symbol or number should be stipulated when requesting copies.)

7.2.2 *Type II.*—Beef tongues procured by the Armed Forces shall be type II.

7.2.3 *Requirements.*—In addition to the requirements specified in section 3, product procured for Armed Forces use shall comply with 7.2.3.1 through 7.2.3.5.

7.2.3.1 *Material.*—The provisions of 3.1 shall apply except that the tongues shall be of standard conventional short cut trim with the tongue root removed at the base (thick end) by a cut made close to and directly behind the hyoid (U shaped) bones, removing a portion of the hinge bones and all of the gullet, soft palate and rings of the trachea (windpipe). Unless otherwise specified, the hyoid bones, cartilages, the epiglottis and portion of the hinge bones (which shall not protrude over the end of the tongue) may be left on the tongue.

7.2.3.2 *Type II, special.*—The provisions of 3.2.2 shall apply, except that frozen and defrosted beef tongues may, subject to the limitations specified in tables I and II, be used for fresh, cured, or smoked beef tongues which are to be delivered in the frozen state, provided the tongues show no evidence of freezer damage and meet other requirements of this specification.

TABLE I.—*Permissible use of and allowable storage periods for frozen uncured tongues to be used in shipments of chilled or frozen fresh tongues*

Class A (fresh tongues)	Frozen uncured tongues (Maximum storage periods)
For domestic consumption:	
(a) Chilled (not to be frozen for delivery)	Not permitted
(b) Frozen (to be frozen for delivery)	60 days (see 7.2.6) 120 days (see 7.2.6)
For overseas consumption:	
(a) Frozen (to be frozen for delivery)	Not permitted

TABLE II.—*Permissible use of and allowable storage periods for frozen uncured or frozen cured tongues to be used in shipments of chilled or frozen cured and smoked tongues*

Class B (cured tongues) Class C (smoked tongues)	Frozen uncured tongues (Maximum storage periods)	Frozen cured tongues (Maximum storage periods)
For domestic consumption:		
(a) Chilled (not to be frozen for delivery)	120 days	Not permitted
(b) Frozen (to be frozen for delivery)	60 days (see 7.2.6) 120 days (see 7.2.6)	60 days
For overseas consumption:		
(a) Frozen (to be frozen for delivery)	Not permitted	Not permitted

7.2.3.3 *Curing.*—The drained cured weight shall not exceed the trimmed uncured weight by more than 15 percent.

7.2.3.4 *Class C, smoked.*—The hinge (hyoid) bones shall be removed at the first cartilaginous joint where they protrude from

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the skin surface. The finished smoked weight shall not exceed the trimmed uncured weight.

7.2.3.5 *Thawing of frozen product for further processing.*—Thawing may be accomplished in air, water, or mild brine (10° to 20° salometer strength) provided the internal and surface temperature of the product being thawed is maintained at 50° F. or lower, from one hour after entering the thawing medium to completion of thawing. Subsequent to thawing, the product shall be held at temperatures of 40° F. or lower.

7.2.4 *Packaging, packing, labeling, and marking for domestic and overseas shipment.* — The product shall be packaged, packed, labeled and marked in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–1018.

7.2.5 *Ordering data.*—In addition to the information required in 6.1, procurement documents should specify whether shipment is to be packaged, packed, labeled, and marked for domestic or overseas shipment.

7.2.6 *Information for procurement, distribution, and storage personnel.*

Storage limits for frozen product are as follows:

Frozen, class A, fresh tongues

Raw material	*To be consumed within*
Prepared from unfrozen tongues	180 days
Prepared from tongues frozen uncured 60 days	120 days
Prepared from tongues frozen uncured 120 days	60 days

Frozen, class B, cured and class C, smoked tongues

Raw material	*To be consumed within*
Prepared from unfrozen tongues	120 days
Prepared from tongues frozen uncured 60 days	60 days
Prepared from tongues frozen uncured 120 days	30 days
Prepared from tongues frozen cured 60 days	30 days

ARMY INTEREST: Q *M*
NAVY INTEREST: S *MC*

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